

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 949

By Watson

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Laura Jane Travis for her service to the citizens of Rhea County.

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly should acknowledge and applaud those community leaders who are wholly devoted to enhancing the quality of life for their fellow citizens and improving and enriching the place they all call home; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Laura Jane Travis of Rhea County, who has distinguished herself as a citizen of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, an active member of the Rhea County Republican Party since 2012, Ms. Travis, as a member of Strong Women, coordinated a 2016 event at the Rhea County Courthouse featuring First Lady Crissy Haslam; the event raised \$14,000 in funds for Rhea Historical Society and the United Way of Rhea County, earmarked for the Imagination Library; and

WHEREAS, Laura Travis created and implemented the Rhea County Restoration Task Force, also serving as its chairman; this eighteen-month project, begun in 2017, secured funding to upgrade and renovate portions of the Rhea County Courthouse, in addition to renovating the entirety of the Rhea Heritage and Scopes Trial Museum; and

WHEREAS, as chairman of the Task Force, she coordinated with the Tennessee State Museum, the Tennessee State Historian, and various local and elected officials and leaders; and

WHEREAS, in further testament to her dedication to her community, Ms. Travis also created a committee composed exclusively of women volunteers to raise awareness and funds to renovate, decorate, and prepare the 12th Judicial District Children's Advocacy Center; the

committee raised \$35,000 in a short period while coordinating structural improvement, interior and exterior maintenance upgrades, and aesthetic enhancements to create an efficient, happy, and nurturing environment; and

WHEREAS, her singular record of service also includes her role as a Tennessee Achieves mentor for the Tennessee Promise scholarship program at Rhea County High School and her membership in the Dayton Rotary Club; and

WHEREAS, Laura Travis epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Ms. Travis for her many years of astute leadership and compassionate service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Laura Jane Travis for her devoted service to Rhea County, commending her leadership and her many indelible contributions, which will continue to improve the well-being of her fellow citizens for years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.